

Patient Flow Pilot — September Checkpoint

West Capacity & Patient Flow Program. Operating committee, September 17, 2026. Pilot units: 4 West, 5 West and Telemetry at Medical Center West, live since March 2, 2026.

Where we said we would be

January charter aim: 30% of pilot-unit discharges before 11 a.m. by August 31, with lower ED boarding for pilot units as a secondary aim.

Pilot live March 2 as planned

EHR next-day discharge list live April 20 (paper list until then)

90-day review held June 4

What changed on the units

Expected discharge date set by day 2 on most admissions

Next-day discharge list agreed at 3 p.m. on each unit

9:30 huddle now reports planned early discharges and barriers

EVS notified when the patient leaves rather than at EHR release

Discharge timing results

Share of discharges before 11 a.m., three pilot units combined: 14.3% before the pilot (February 1 to March 1, 419 discharges) and 27.1% from March 2 to August 31 (2,793 discharges).

Monthly: 25.0% March, 29.7% April, 23.4% May, 28.2% June, 27.4% July, 28.3% August

Target of 30% not reached in any month

Comparison units (Progressive Care, 6 West) did not change

Boarding and season

ED boarding hours for pilot units fell from about 13.4 per unit-day in February to 9.6 in June to August. Other West units fell by a similar share, from 4.4 to 3.0.

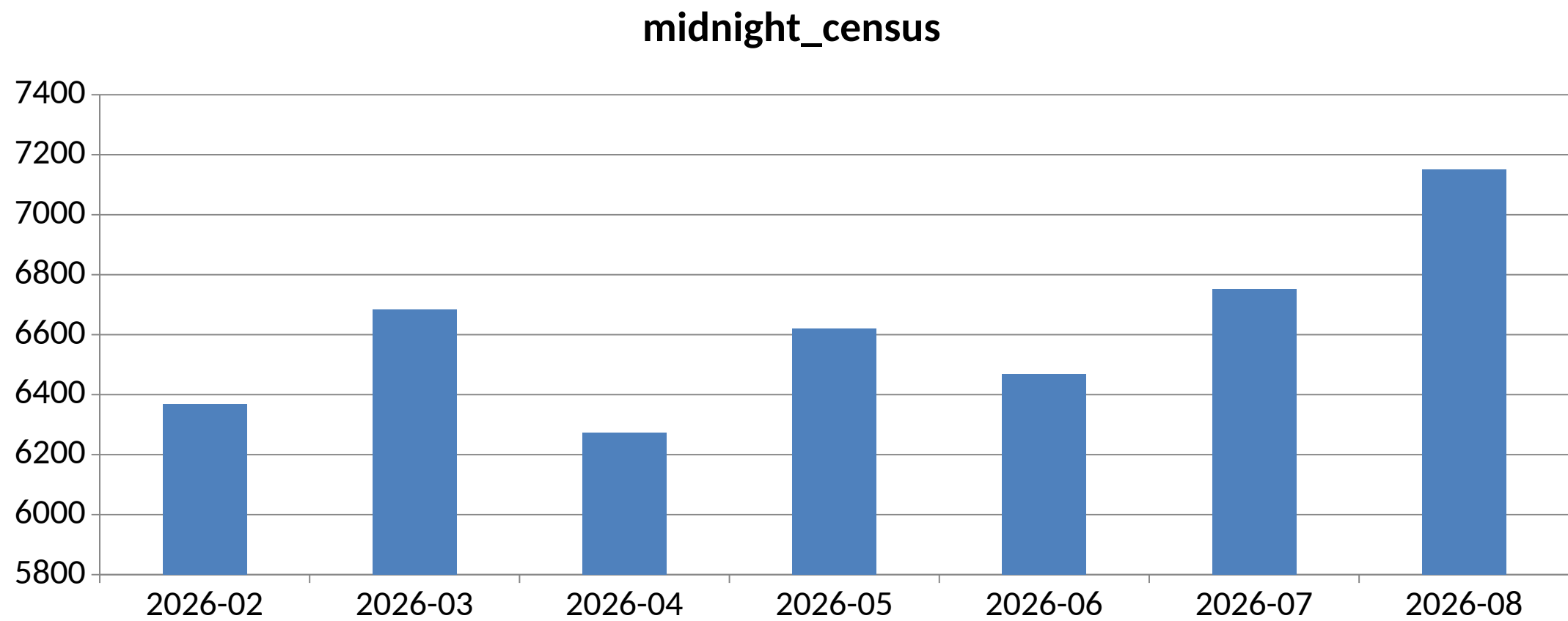
West boarding totaled 1,741 hours in February, 1,150 in June and 1,489 in August

West census rose again in August

Census context, February to August

Monthly census-days for all 12 units at both hospitals, including observation patients.

Census context, February to August • patients



What we cannot conclude yet

Whether earlier discharges reduced boarding once season is accounted for

Whether the gain will hold during winter census

Effect on readmissions: no concerns logged, but the data are thin

Recommendation for October

Continue the pilot unchanged through December 2026

Spread to Progressive Care and 6 West in January 2027 if approved

Keep the 30% target

Add a 10 a.m. discharge-readiness call between case management and hospitalists

Next steps

Decision Support to add a same-month-last-year boarding comparison by unit

Unit leads to prepare the spread training plan

Report winter results in February 2027